

Report Summary: 0037. TLP: CLEAR			Date	Breakout Scale
Title	EU,			
	IL	Illegal Russian Influence Operations Continue Despite Sanctions	23/12/2024	2

Summary

- Between November 3rd and December 4th 2024, 959 Doppelganger tweets were identified,
- The geolocation-based redirect has broken and the influence operation used the same four IPs for their front domains.
- 4 New Doppelganger domains were identified, using Canadian and British Domain registrars.
- Most relevant narratives: trying to dissuade the West from supporting Ukraine and re-direct U.S. support to Israel.
- The tweets received 4 million views.
- Doppelganger should be investigated as a sanctions violation, on top of already being investigated as a DSA violation.

Incident

Between November 3rd and December 4th 2024, 959 Doppelganger tweets were identified. Out of 959 tweets, 329 did not have Doppelganger links in them. Considering the sanctions on the Doppelganger operator SDA, these tweets could potentially be considered illegal content.

The influence operation shows no clear change in sharing patterns, still allowing us to automatically track it based on its behaviour. X has yet to address the issue that was flagged to them in our September report, despite being informed about how we track the influence operation.

The geolocation-based redirect method that takes a user from the front domain used in tweets to eventually the Doppelganger website is seemingly broken.

In our dataset, we repeatedly identified the same set of four IP addresses being used by the Doppelganger front-domains. We identified 4 new Doppelganger domains: Spiegel(.)cx, News(.)walla(.)top, Leparisien(.)fyi, Lepoint(.)top.

Narrative

Russia perceives Ukraine's use of U.S. weapons against its territory as a direct attack by the United States; Calls for a cease-fire in Ukraine and peace negotiations; Calls for the change of European governments and for protests against European governments; Support for Israel and spreading fear amongst European Jews.

Impact

According to data from X's API, the tweets received 4,135,274 views. These numbers are unreliable.

Key Objectives and Behaviours (DISARM Red Framework)

Objective: [Smear](#) - Smear EU member state governments and Ukraine.

Objective: [Discourage](#) - The influence operation is trying to discourage the targeted countries to support Ukraine.

[Post Inauthentic Social Media Comment](#) - SDA quote tweets their posts to comment on other users' posts.

[Conceal Network Identity](#) - The accounts are not revealing that they are part of a larger network.

[Conduct Server Redirect](#) - The posts contain redirect URLs that obfuscate them to avoid content moderation.

[Domain Asset](#) - The influence operation is using look-alike domains to give legitimacy to the influence operation.

Recommendations and Actions Taken

Actions taken: Alert sent to X and European governments – 23/12/2024.

X address the systemic risk that the Doppelganger influence operation might entail;

The legal implications of Doppelganger freely operating should not only be seen from a DSA perspective but also be investigated as a sanctions violation.

Report	Topic	Evidence	Authors and Contributors	Content type	Platforms
Link	Doppelganger, Israel, Germany, France,	Contact for dataset.	Saman Nazari, Alliance4Europe, Contributor: Lea Frühwirth, CeMAS	Posts, images, videos.	X